

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Suspected stroke

MEDICAL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Sudden facial droop, arm weakness or speech trouble may be a stroke. Call the local emergency number immediately, note when symptoms began or the person was last well, and stay with them. Symptoms that disappear still need urgent medical evaluation.

Do now.

- ☐ **Recognize sudden changes**
01 Use FAST: Face droop, Arm weakness, Speech difficulty, Time to act. Sudden loss of balance, vision changes or severe headache can also matter.
- ☐ **Record the time**
02 Write down symptom onset or the last time the person was known well. Do not delay seeking care while completing a checklist.
- ☐ **Protect breathing**
03 Keep them comfortable. If not fully awake but breathing, place on their side when safe. Do not give food, drink or medication to someone with swallowing difficulty.
- ☐ **Watch responsiveness**
04 If unresponsive and not breathing normally, begin CPR and use an AED. Follow dispatcher instructions when available.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Keep attempting to reach urgent medical care while watching breathing and responsiveness. Tell a trusted person the exact location and last-known-well time. Do not make the affected person walk or drive. An inaccessible ambulance service does not make home observation a treatment.

Watch for.

Do not assume FAST rules out stroke; children and some adults have other symptoms. Do not use aspirin as stroke treatment without clinical direction.

People & practical needs.

Speech difficulty can prevent a person from telling others what they need. Use short questions, allow time and avoid asking them to repeat a long history

Next decision.

Pass the symptom timeline to the receiving clinician. Even a brief episode or apparent recovery needs urgent assessment.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

INCIDENT / SYMPTOM ONSET / LOCATION

HELP REQUESTED / RESPONSE CONFIRMED

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

American Red Cross – Stroke

AHA / Red Cross – 2024 first-aid guidelines

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/stroke/>